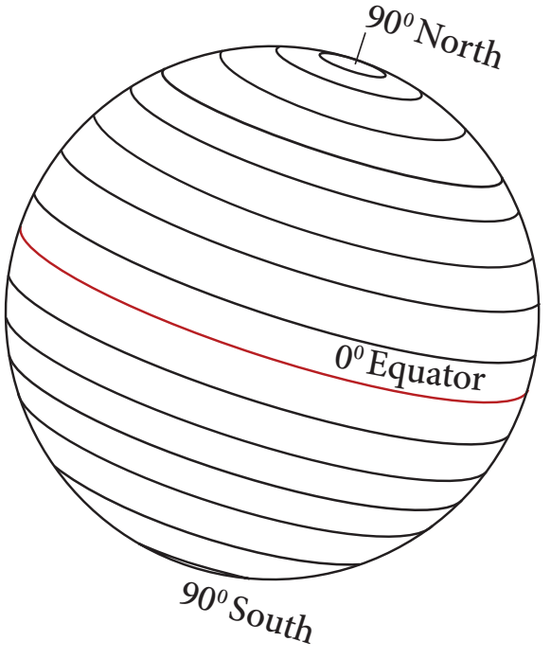


Since the Earth is geoid shaped, the length of the lines of latitude decreases from the Equator towards the South and North Poles. The 90° North and South Poles are not found as lines, but as points.

The lines of latitude that are drawn horizontally between the Equator and the North Pole are called **'Northern latitudes'** and those which are found between the Equator and the South Pole are called **'Southern Latitudes'.**

The lines of latitude consist of **89** parallels in the Northern Hemisphere and **89** parallels in the Southern Hemisphere, **one** at the Equator and the **two** poles are found as points. Totally, there are **181 parallels** found on earth.

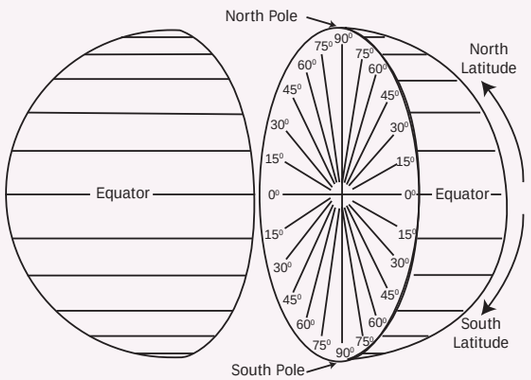


The Equator is the longest of all lines of latitude. Hence, it is also known as **'The Great Circle'.**

Activity :



Draw a circle on a paper. Draw a horizontal line across the middle of a circle. Keeping this line as 0°, draw lines on both sides with an equal interval of 15° with the help of a protractor. The lines you have drawn are lines of latitudes.



Northern Hemisphere

